

INDIA TODAY

www.indiatoday.com

Editor-in-Chief: Aron Purie
Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla

Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankar Aiyar

Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai

Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta,

Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra

Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta,

HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon

Photo Editor: Bandep Singh

Art Editor: Sapna Kapoor

Associate Editors: S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan,

AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar, CHANDIGARH: Ramesh Vinayak,

LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra

Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee,

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen

Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahman, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar,

BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran

Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish,

BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra,

MUMBAI: Aditi Pai, PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava

Copy Desk: Shalini S. Sharma (Assistant Editor), Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar,

Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shijith P.K., Shipi, Priyanka Sood,

Shveta Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav

Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbanti Negi,

Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh,

AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar,

MUMBAI: Mandar Doodhar, Shriya Paul, Bhaskar Paul,

Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)

Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh

Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji,

Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rasshi Ajmanni Girdhar,

Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur

Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),

Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry

Associate Publisher: Manoj Sharma (Impact)

IMPACT TEAM

Senior General Manager: Upendra Wellingkar (West and South)

General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram (Chennai),

Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lad (West)

Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha, Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director

D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager

Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)

Deepak Bhatt, General Manager, Sales (North)

Rajesh Menon, General Manager (West)

Krishna Kiran Mandpaka, Deputy General Manager, Sales (South)

S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIII Number 45: For the week Nov 4-10, 2008, released on Nov 3

Editorial Office: Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001. Phones: 23315801-4;

Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi

Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301;

Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from RSN/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and

Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080;

e-mail: ircare@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444423-6; Fax: 24444358; Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to

General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Connaught Place, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place,

New Delhi-110001. Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001. Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor,

Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Ground Floor, Mumbai 400016; Phone: 24982266; Fax: 24982266; Hamilton

House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330; 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai,

2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177 Into In; Fax: 28472178; Cable:

Livmedia Chennai; 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones:

22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore; 52, Jawaharalal Nehru Road,

4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata; 6-3-885/7B,

Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498;

Fax: 23403484 & 391045, Karakatt Parel, Mumbai 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059

; 2C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006;

Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293

Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is

prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press

India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007. (Haryana);

A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, district Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and

at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra).

Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.

INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

The image of the Indian politician is already the pits. They are generally regarded as corrupt, often criminal, unscrupulous, power-hungry, incompetent and sometimes just plain stupid. As if this were not enough there emerges on the political landscape a politician who brings this discredited profession to further disrepute.

Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) leader Raj Thackeray is spreading his politics of hate and division in India's most cosmopolitan of cities, its commercial hub Mumbai. Once considered the most progressive of cities, Mumbai now lives under the shadow of goondaraj. Demonising a community of 'outsiders' for the ills facing the locals is an instant formula for gaining popularity as it appeals to the basest of human emotions—envy. So in Mumbai, north Indian taxi drivers have been attacked, vehicles burnt and property destroyed, all in the name of protecting the interests of Maharashtrians.

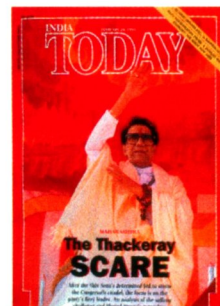
Raj Thackeray has learnt well at the hands of his mentor and uncle Bal Thackeray who applied the same tactics in the 1970s to gain a political foothold but has since tried to broaden his appeal by toning down his rhetoric. The vacuum he left has been being filled by the nephew making the most of a family feud. What is new in this scenario is the cynical, self-serving politics of the Congress-NCP Democratic Front alliance in Maharashtra who have done everything in their power to protect their political interests but not the well-being of the average citizen.

Arrested in February for "promoting enmity", Thackeray Jr was released on bail and warned against whipping up sentiments against the city's economic migrants. That is exactly what he did and the panic has caused many to flee Mumbai. Civil society has been unable to respond, trapped and at the mercy of violent mobs. The men and women whose industry fuelled Mumbai's growth have been turned into political capital.

The waning strength of the Shiv Sena and the increasing prominence of Raj Thackeray has given the Democratic Front alliance an ideal opportunity. Every vote split between the Shiv Sena and the MNS is another vote for Maharashtra's incompetent incumbents. Up north, politicians from Bihar and Uttar Pradesh are not far behind in terms of opportunism. They have grabbed at this emotive issue to cover up their own inadequacies. Our cover story this week is about the politics of shame and the games politicians play for power.

What Mumbai has witnessed in recent months strikes at the heart of the idea of India as a nation. A country proud of its unity in diversity cannot be allowed to be hijacked by a bunch of demagogues and self-serving politicians. It is time for politicians to fight a fair fight and not clamber to power over the bodies of our hapless citizens.

Aaron Purie
(Aron Purie)



Our Feb 1995 cover